

To: Prof. Dr. Iryna Gurevych

Email: iryna.gurevych@tu-darmstadt.de

Subject: Application for Postdoctoral Researcher for the ERC Advanced Grant InterText — Ref [TODO: verify with user] — Nauval Zulfikar

Dear Prof. Dr. Gurevych,

I am writing to express my interest in the position of Postdoctoral Researcher for the ERC Advanced Grant InterText at the UKP Lab, Technische Universität Darmstadt. I am available to start on 1 September 2026, aligning with your department's timeline.

Your work on [TODO: verify supervisor paper title via Google Scholar] has been particularly inspiring to me, especially in how it addresses the challenges of automated fact-checking and misinformation detection. This aligns closely with my research interests and expertise in NLP and AI-driven solutions.

During my MSc in Business Analytics at Aston University, I completed a dissertation titled "Enhancing Supply Chain Information Sharing Systems Through Blockchain: Integrated Customer Reviews LLM Analysis: A Smart Contract Approach." This project involved fine-tuning DeBERTa-v3 transformers, which directly relates to your research themes of multi-document reasoning and long-context LLMs.

Additionally, my recent project, "LLM-Generated Adaptive Shipper Decision Rules," utilized a retrieval-augmented generation system with OpenAI's gpt-4o-mini, showcasing my ability to develop reproducible and ablatable systems. This experience is particularly relevant to the themes of AI for Science and scientific evidence synthesis that your lab focuses on.

I acknowledge that my academic background in Business Analytics might differ from a traditional Computer Science path. However, I have consistently applied machine learning and NLP techniques across various domains, including my role as a Data Scientist & Project Manager at the Public Works & Spatial Planning Department in Indonesia, where I led projects that improved data efficiency and project delivery times.

I have attached my CV, transcripts, and reference letters for your review. I am eager to contribute to the InterText project and look forward to the possibility of discussing my application further.

Sincerely,

Nauval Zulfikar

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